

FLōSim Add-in Installation Guide

Excel Statistical Simulation Library

Download the [flosim.xlam](#) file and follow the instructions for your operating system below.

⚠ Do not rename the file. The add-in must be named exactly `flosim.xlam`. If you download the file into a folder that already contains `flosim.xlam`, your browser or operating system may save it as `flosim (1).xlam`. Renaming the file will prevent the add-in from functioning correctly. Delete the old copy first, then download the new one.

⚠ Install on your local machine only. The `.xlam` file must be stored on your local hard drive. Do **not** place it on OneDrive, SharePoint, a network share, or any cloud-synced folder. Suitable locations include `Documents`, `Downloads`, or `Applications` on your local disk. Remote or synced paths prevent Excel from loading macros correctly.

ℹ Web version not supported. This add-in requires a desktop installation of Excel. Excel for the Web (browser-based) is **not** supported.

Windows

Windows

1. Unblock the file first.

- Close Excel completely.
- Right-click `flosim.xlam` and choose **Properties**.
- On the **General** tab, check the box labelled **Unblock**.
- Click **Apply** and **OK**.

⚠ This step is mandatory on Windows. If the file is not unblocked, Excel may keep macros disabled even if the add-in is installed correctly.

2. Install the add-in using one of the two methods below.

Option A: Load the add-in manually.

- Open Excel.
- Go to **File** → **Options** → **Add-ins**.
- At the bottom of the dialog, set **Manage** to **Excel Add-ins** and click **Go**.
- Click **Browse**, select `flosim.xlam`, and click **OK**.
- Make sure the checkbox next to the add-in is selected.

Option B: Place the add-in in Excel's startup folder. After unblocking the file, copy `flosim.xlam` directly into:

`C:\Program Files\Microsoft Office\root\Office16\XLSTART`

With this option, Excel loads the add-in automatically when Excel starts. You do not need to browse for the add-in manually.

i Administrator permission may be required. Because this folder is inside `Program Files`, Windows may ask for administrator permission when copying the file.

3. Enable macros if needed.

- a. Open Excel and go to **File** → **Options** → **Trust Center** → **Trust Center Settings**.
- b. Select **Macro Settings**.
- c. Choose either **Disable all macros except digitally signed macros** or **Enable all macros**.
- d. Click **OK**.

4. Verify installation.

Open Excel and check that the `FL̄Sim` tab appears. Then, in a blank cell, enter:

`=norm()`

If the add-in is installed correctly, Excel should return a numeric value.

✔ Installation successful if the `FL̄Sim` tab appears and `=norm()` returns a number. A `#NAME?` error usually means Excel does not recognize the add-in, the file was not unblocked, or the file name is not exactly `flosim.xlam`.

macOS

🍏 macOS requirement: Excel 2021 or later, or Microsoft 365, is required for full compatibility with `flosim.xlam`.

1. Open Microsoft Excel.
2. In the menu bar, click **Tools** → **Excel Add-ins**.
3. In the Add-ins dialog, click **Browse**.
4. Navigate to the local folder where you saved `flosim.xlam`, select it, and click **Open**.
5. Ensure the checkbox next to the add-in name is checked, then close the dialog. The add-in should now be active.
6. **Verify installation.** In a blank cell, enter:

`=norm()`

If the add-in is installed and trusted, the function evaluates normally (no `#NAME?` error).

✔ **Installation successful** if the cell returns a numeric result. A **#NAME?** error means the add-in is not recognized — recheck the steps above and ensure macros are enabled.

❗ **Enabling macros on macOS.** Macros must be enabled under **Excel → Preferences → Security** for the add-in to function properly.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Fix
#NAME? error after loading	Unblock the file (Windows); verify the exact file name is flosim.xlam ; re-enable macros.
Functions disappear after restarting Excel	The add-in was loaded from a remote or cloud-synced location. Move it to a local folder and re-load.
File saved as flosim (1).xlam	Delete the duplicate, rename the file back to flosim.xlam , and reload.
Macros disabled warning on open	Complete the Unblock step on Windows; adjust macro settings in Trust Center / Security preferences.